

Yanfei Lu

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I. Education

- 2022-Present **PhD, Linguistics, University of Toronto, Toronto ON, Canada**
Thesis topic: *Documenting Oneida Phonetics for Revitalization: Consonants, Vowels, and Prosody*
Committee: Alexei Kochetov, Laura Colantoni, Karin Michelson
- 2020-2022 **MA, Linguistics, University of Western Ontario, London ON, Canada**
Major Research Paper title: *Orthographic Variations among Oneida (Iroquoian) Sources: Understanding the Differences for Better Interpretations*
Supervisor: Tania Granadillo
Second Reader: David Heap
- 2017-2020 **BA, Honours Specialization in Linguistics, University of Western Ontario, London ON, Canada**
Certificate in Practical Spanish
Graduated with Distinction
- 2012-2014 **Diploma, Early Childhood Education, Fanshawe College, London ON, Canada**

II. Publications

Refereed Publications

- 2026 Yang, C., Littell, P., Bernier-Colborne, G., **Lu, Y.**, & Geng M. (2026, May). GlossMATE: Multi-Agent Translator Explanations for Glosses. In *Proceedings of the 2026 Language Resources and Evaluation Conference (LREC 26)*.
- 2024 **Lu, Y.**, Littell, P., & Rice, K. (2024, May). Empowering Oneida language revitalization: Development of an Oneida verb conjugator. In *Proceedings of the 2024 Joint International Conference on Computational Linguistics, Language Resources and Evaluation (LREC-COLING 2024)* (pp. 5757-5767).

Other Publication

- 2021 **Lu, Y.** (2021, September). Preservation of Indigenous Languages: Revitalization of Oneida (Iroquoian). *Inspiring Minds – Showcasing Western's Graduate Research, Scholarship and Creative Activity*. 72.

III. Invited Talks and Presentations

- May 2026 **Arts & Science Teaching & Learning Showcase, University of Toronto, Canada**
 - Writing-Integrated Teaching (WIT) repository for low-stakes writing activities

- March 2026 **Linguistics Talks Western, University of Western Ontario, London ON, Canada**
- An Analysis of Oneida Stop Consonants /t/ and /k/ and their Acquisition by Adult L2 Learners

IV. Conference Presentations

- Dec 2026 Lu, Yanfei, Elvis Batung, and Samuel Akinbo. “From Folktales to Multimodal Resources: A Collaborative Project for Dagaare Language and Literacy”. Presentation at The African Studies Association 2026 Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA, USA
- June 2026 Lu, Yanfei, Nancy George, and Alexei Kochetov. “Production of Oneida Stops and Allophonic Variation by L1 and L2 Speakers”. Poster presentation at the Conference on Laboratory Phonology (LabPhon 20), Montreal, QC, Canada
- May 2026 Lu, Yanfei, Alyssa Vorobey, Max Zuercher, Natalia Liu, Xinyan Qian, Fiona John, Sandra Glozshstein, Elvis Batung, Alex Angsongna, Samuel Akinbo, and Douglas Pulleyblank. “Language Reclamation through Stories: A Collaborative Project with Dagaaba Community Members”. Poster presentation at the Annual Conference on African Linguistics (ACAL 57), Buffalo, NY, USA
- May 2026 Yang, Changbing, Patrick Littell, Gabriel Bernier-Colborne, Yanfei Lu, and Mengzhe Geng. “GlossMATE: Multi-Agent Translator Explanations for Glosses” Poster presentation at the 2026 Language Resources and Evaluation Conference (LREC 26), Palma, Mallorca, Spain
- April 2025 Lu, Yanfei. “An Analysis of Phonetic Acquisition of L2 Oneida by Adult English L1 Learners”. Doctoral Workshop Presentation at the 11th International Symposium on the Acquisition of Second Language Speech (New Sounds 2025), Toronto, ON, Canada
- May 2024 Lu, Yanfei, Patrick Littell, and Keren Rice. “Empowering Oneida Language Revitalization: Development of An Oneida Verb Conjugator”. Presentation at the 2024 Joint International Conference on Computational Linguistics, Language Resources and Evaluation (LREC-COLING 2024), Turin, Italy
- Jan 2024 Lu, Yanfei. “Digital Tool for Revitalization of the Oneida language: Verb Conjugator”. Presentation at the Society for the Study of Indigenous Languages of the Americas (SSILA) 2024 Annual Meeting, New York City NY, USA
- *Best Student Paper Award*
- Jun 2023 Lu, Yanfei. “An Analysis of Orthographic Variations among Oneida Iroquoian Sources”. Poster presentation at the Annual Conference of the Canadian Linguistic Association (ACL|CLA), York University, Toronto, ON, Canada
- May 2023 Lu, Yanfei. “Digital Tool for Revitalization of the Oneida language: Verb Conjugator”. Presentation at the Workshop on Language Documentation and Revitalization - Celebration of Keren Rice’s Retirement

Oct 2022	Lu, Yanfei. “An Analysis of Orthographic Variations among Oneida Sources”. Presentation at 14 th Linguistics Graduate Course Union (LGCU) Welcome Workshop, University of Toronto, Toronto ON, Canada
Jan 2021	Lu, Yanfei and Tania Granadillo. “Understanding Adult Learners’ Acquisition of Oneida Pronominal Prefix”. Presentation at the Society for the Study of Indigenous Languages of the Americas (SSILA) 2021 Annual Meeting, held online
Mar 2020	Lu, Yanfei. “How do Adult L2 Learners Acquire Pronominal Prefixes of Oneida (Iroquoian)”. Presentation at Toronto Undergraduate Linguistics Conference 2020 (TULCON 13), University of Toronto, Toronto ON, Canada
Feb 2020	Lu, Yanfei. “Acquisition of Pronominal Prefixes in Oneida by Adult Native English Speakers”. Presentation at Western Interdisciplinary Student Symposium on Language Research (WISSLR), University of Western Ontario, London ON, Canada
Jul 2019	Lu, Yanfei. “How do Bilingual Young Women Create Solidarity through Stance-taking and Construction of Similar Identities in Text messages?”. Poster Presentation at LSA Linguistic Institute, University of California, Davis, Davis CA, USA
Mar 2019	Lu, Yanfei. “Stance-taking and Construction of Similar Identities Help Bilingual Young Women Create Solidarity in Text messages”. Presentation at Western Interdisciplinary Student Symposium on Language Research (WISSLR), University of Western Ontario, London ON, Canada

V. Fellowships and Awards

University of Toronto

2024	Dresher Prize in Phonology	\$800
2023-2026	Canada Graduate Scholarship-Doctoral Program (CGS D)	\$115,000
2023-2024	Barbara Frum Memorial Award in Canadian Scholarship	\$8,000
2023-2024	Connaught PhDs for Public Impact Fellowship	\$12,500
Mar 2023	3 Minutes Thesis Competition (3MT)	Semi-finalist
Dec 2022	The 9 th U of T Most Understandable Scientist (UTMUST) Presentation Competition	First Prize

The Institute on Collaborative Language Research (CoLang 2024)

Jun 2024	Internal Scholarship	\$4,859 (USD)
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University of California, Santa Barbara

2022-2027	Department of Linguistics Fellowship (Declined)	≥ \$227,277 (USD)
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University of Western Ontario

2021-2022	Ontario Graduate Scholarship (OGS)	\$15,000
2020-2021	Canadian Graduate Scholarships-Master’s Program (CGSM)	\$17,500

2020-2021	Ontario Graduate Scholarship (OGS) (Declined)	\$15,000
2020	Faculty of Arts and Humanities Dean's Entrance Scholarship	\$2,000
2019-2020	Bentley Scholarship and Gold Medal in Arts and Humanities	\$1,000
2019-2020	Faculty of Arts and Humanities Scholarship	\$1,800
2019-2020	UWO In-course Scholarships Year IV	\$700
2018-2019	Western Alumni Global Opportunities Award in Arts and Humanities	\$2,000
2018-2019	UWO In-course Scholarships Year III	\$700
2018-2019	Memorial Scholarship	\$1,250
2017-2020	Dean's Honor List	

Fanshawe College

2014	President's Honour Roll	
2013-2014	International Returning Student Award	\$2,000
2013 Winter & Fall; 2014 Winter	Dean's Honour Roll	

VI. Research Fundings

University of Toronto

Feb 2026	Graduate Research Awards (GRAs)	\$636.54
Sept 2024	Summer 2024 School of Graduate Studies (SGS) Conference Grant	\$1,050
Jun 2024	Spring 2024 SSHRC Institutional Grant (SIG) Program/Departmental Research Funds	\$577.63
Jun 2023	The Study Elsewhere of Less Commonly Taught (SELECT) Language for Research Purposes Fund	\$2,500
Dec 2022	2022-23 SSHRC Institutional Grant (SIG) Program/Departmental Research Funds	\$480

VII. Teaching Experiences

2026 Summer	Course Instructor, University of Toronto, Canada LIN101H1F – Introduction to Linguistics: Sound Structure ○ Design and deliver in-person lectures for an undergraduate course with around 60 students enrolled ○ Develop and administer course assessments, ensuring alignment with learning objectives ○ Hold regular office hours to provide individualized academic support and foster student engagement with course material ○ Supervise and collaborate with two teaching assistants on course delivery and grading
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- 2024-present **Lead Writing Teaching Assistant (LWTA), University of Toronto, Canada**
- Collaborated with a co-LWTA to support 8-10 undergraduate courses annually, partnering with instructors and 30+ TAs to integrate discipline-specific writing instruction, collectively reaching over 1,500 students
 - Designed and facilitated TA training workshops on writing pedagogy and effective feedback practices
 - Collaborated with faculty and cross-departmental LWTAs to develop instructional resources; disseminated at the 2025-26 Teaching & Learning Showcase of the Faculty of Arts & Science
 - Contributed to program assessment and authored annual reports
- 2022-Present **Teaching Assistantship, University of Toronto, Canada**
- Evaluated and provided detailed feedback on assignments, tests, and examinations, ensuring consistency and transparency in grading practices
 - Led in-person tutorial sessions, clarified course concepts, facilitated discussion, and supported students' analytical and writing skills
 - As Head TA, reviewed assessment materials and served as liaison between instructional team members
 - LIN101H1F – Introduction to Linguistics: Sound Structure (Fall 2025; Fall 2024 (Head TA); Fall 2022)
 - LIN101H5F – Introduction to General Linguistics: The Sounds of Language (short term replacement) (Dec 2024)
 - LIN102H1S – Introduction to Linguistics: Sentence Structure and Meaning (Winter 2023)
 - LIN229H1S – Phonological Patterns (Winter 2025; Winter 2024)
- 2020-2022 **Graduate Teaching Assistantship, University of Western Ontario, London ON, Canada**
- Facilitated student engagement through structured discussions, applied exercises, and effective feedback
 - Designed and delivered weekly tutorial sessions, developed instructional materials aligned with course objectives
 - Assisted course instructors in the preparation of lecture materials and assessments
 - LINGUIST 2247B – Phonological Analysis (Winter 2022)
 - LINGUIST 2248A/B – Syntactic Analysis (Fall 2021; Winter 2021)
 - LINGUIST 3102A – Linguistics Analysis with Computers (Fall 2020)

VIII. Research Assistantship

- 2025-present **Research Assistant, University of Toronto, Canada**
- Yiddish Revitalization Project, supervised by Dr. Avery Ozburn
- Led the development of digital read-along books to create interactive and accessible learning resources for Yiddish learners

- 2024-present **Research Assistant, University of Toronto, Canada**
Documenting and Describing African Languages Project, supervised by Dr. Samuel Akinbo
- Coordinated the development of language resources (read-along books, printable materials, and videos) from Dagaare documentation data
 - Supervised and trained a team of 10 undergraduate research assistants; organized regular team meetings and oversaw workflow; worked with native Dagaare speakers to review materials for accuracy and appropriateness
- 2022-2023 **Research Assistant, Indigenous Language Revitalization Team at the University of Toronto, Canada**
Community-University Partnership in Indigenous Language Revitalization supervised by Dr. Susana Bejar
- Coordinated logistics for two partnership meetings between university researchers and representatives of Kanyen'kéha language programs from two communities
 - Participated in discussions on community-identified needs and interests and institutional support strategies and contributed to a report disseminated at the university level to guide further collaborations
- May-Aug 2020 **Undergraduate Student Research Internship, University of Western Ontario, London ON, Canada**
Supervised by Dr. Tania Granadillo and Dr. David Heap
- Transcribed and annotated recordings of Oneida speech by L2 learners in support of research on language acquisition and revitalization

IX. Service and Extracurricular Activities

- 2026 **Reviewer**
Coyote Papers, Volume 28
Department of Linguistics, University of Arizona
- Sept 2024-present **Student Officer**
Committee on Indigenous Languages and their Sustainability (COILS), Linguistic Society of America (LSA)
(Formerly Committee on Endangered Languages and Their Preservation (CELP))
- Represented student perspectives on the committee; coordinated regular meetings, authored quarterly newsletters, and promoted membership and conference events
 - Collaborated closely with co-chairs to organize a special session at the 2026 LSA Annual Meeting
 - Supported the committee's name-change process by designing and distributing surveys, analyzing feedback, and drafting final report

2024-2025	Co-coordinator Language Description, Documentation and Revitalization Group (LDDR), University of Toronto, Canada ○ Co-led the research group; organized biweekly meetings and invited speakers from within and outside the department to facilitate scholarly exchange
2021-2025	Panelist ○ <i>Graduate School Application Seminar</i>, Society of Linguistics Undergraduate Students, University of Toronto (Oct 2025) ○ <i>Alumni Panel: What's next after my Linguistics degree</i>, University of Western Ontario (Nov 2023) ○ <i>School of Graduate Studies Orientation</i>, University of Toronto (Sept 2023) ○ <i>Panel: Life after your degree: How to apply to grad school</i>, University of Western Ontario (Nov 2021)
Jun 2023-Apr 2024	Co-organizer Workshop on Structure and Constituency in Languages of the Americas (WSCLA), University of Toronto, Canada ○ Led logistics coordination and supervised a team of student volunteers to ensure smooth on-site operations; contributed to grant applications, conference promotion, program development, and communication with reviewers and participants
May 2023-Feb 2026	Cohort Member WhereWeStand Project, Canada Excellence Research Chair in Migration and Integration, Toronto Metropolitan University ○ Collaborated with an Ojibwe artist to develop a music and dance performance exploring themes of visibility, identity, and language among Indigenous and immigrant communities in Canada ○ Work premiered at venues including the Canadian Museum of Immigration (Halifax), Woodland Cultural Centre (Six Nations Reserve), Rodman Art Institute of Niagara, the Canadian Museum for Human Rights (Winnipeg), and the 2025 imagineNATIVE Film + Media Arts Festival
Sept 2022-present	Member of Space Committee Linguistics Graduate Course Union (LGPU), University of Toronto, Canada ○ Contributed to the maintenance and enhancement of shared departmental spaces ; supported a clean, organized, and welcoming environment for students and faculty
2022-present	Collaborator National Research Council Canada (NRC), Canadian Indigenous Languages Technology Project (ILT) ○ Collaborated with the Twatati Adult Oneida Language Program and the ILT team at NRC to develop a digital verb conjugator supporting morphological acquisition of Oneida by adult learners; results presented and published

- 2021-2022 **Co-editor-in-chief**
 Western Papers in Linguistics (online journal), University of Western Ontario, London ON, Canada
- Oversaw author communication, supervised undergraduate volunteers, and managed copyediting and publication workflows, resulted in the successful publication of Master's Major Research Papers and the Proceedings of WISSLR 2021
- 2021-2022 **Coordinator**
 Western Interdisciplinary Student Symposium on Language Research (WISSLR), University of Western Ontario, London ON, Canada
- Led a team of five graduate students to organize the symposium featuring keynote speaker and presenters from eight international institutions; chaired sessions and ensured smooth execution and scholarly engagement
- 2020-2021 **Member of Organizing Committee**
 Western Interdisciplinary Student Symposium on Language Research (WISSLR), University of Western Ontario, London ON, Canada
- Coordinated communication with keynote speaker and presenters from five institutions and supported conference planning and logistics, contributed to the successful execution of the event
- 2019-2020 **Student Ambassador**
 Linguistic Society of America (LSA)
- Represented and promoted linguistics and the LSA on campus, encouraged student engagement with the field

X. Additional Education and Training

- Sept 2025-Feb 2026 **Data Science Certificate for U of T Doctoral Students**
 Data Sciences Institute and the School of Graduate Studies, University of Toronto, Canada
- Developed practical skills in Python, SQL, Git, data sampling, and visualization, alongside foundational training in AI and large language model (LLM) applications
- Oct 2024-April 2025 **Oneida Language and Culture Classes**
 Twatati Oneida Language Program, Oneida Nation of the Thames
- Jun 2024 **The Institute on Collaborative Language Research (CoLang)**
 Arizona State University and Salt River Pima-Maricopa Indian Community
- Gained hands-on experience in language documentation, revitalization strategies, and collaborative research methodologies relevant to linguistic fieldwork
- Jun-Jul 2019 **LSA Linguistic Institute**
 Linguistic Society of America, University of California, Davis

- May 2019 **Intermediate Spanish**
Study Abroad Program through the University of Western Ontario, Universidad de Holguín, Cuba
- 2017-2018 **French as a Second Language—Beginner I, II**
Collège Boréal, London ON, Canada

XI. Employment

- 2014-2017 **Early Childhood Educator**
London Bridge Child Care Services Inc., London ON, Canada
- Provided full-time care for children aged 0–4, planned and implemented developmentally appropriate curriculum activities
 - Collaborated with families from diverse backgrounds to support children’s learning and development
 - Monitored and documented children’s progress, and partnered with colleagues to ensure a safe and inclusive classroom environment

XII. Recent Volunteer Experiences

- 2023-2025 **Volunteer**
Cham Shan Temple, Thornhill ON, Canada
- Welcomed and assisted visitors in multiple languages, fostering an inclusive and accessible environment for a diverse community
- 2019-2020 **Student Member**
Cuando el Río Suena Teatro (Spanish Theatre Group), University of Western Ontario, London ON, Canada
- Founding member of London’s first Latinx Spanish-language theatre group, participated in play creation and rehearsals and supported recruitment and community engagement
- 2018, 2019, 2022 **Volunteer at the Linguistics Booth**
Open house and Science Rendezvous events of University of Western Ontario, London ON, Canada
- Engaged visitors of all ages in linguistics demonstrations and activities, explained key concepts in clear, accessible language, and contributed to increased public interest and participation in the field
- 2018-2019 **English Conversation Leader**
University of Western Ontario, London ON, Canada
- Led weekly English conversation sessions for small groups of international students
 - Designed activities to improve English proficiency, conversational skills, and cultural adjustment to Canadian academic and social environments

XIII. Membership

2026-2028	Association for Laboratory Phonology (ALP)
2026	African Studies Association (ASA)
2024-2026	Language Resources Association (ELRA)
2023-2024	Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)
2023-2024	Canadian Linguistic Association (ACL CLA)
2020-present	Society for the Study of Indigenous Languages of the Americas (SSILA)
2018-present	Linguistic Society of America (LSA)

XIV. Languages and Skills

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| • Mandarin (Native) | • ELAN |
| • English (Near native) | • PRAAT |
| • Spanish (Intermediate) | • Python |
| • Kanyen'kéha (Mohawk) (Elementary) | • R |
| • Oneida (Elementary) | • SQL |
| • Korean (Elementary) | |
| • French (Elementary) | |